Qwen

Model Ledger · profile 6 of 20 · revised 21 October 2026 after a review by ChatGPT, Gemini 4 Argon, Kimi K3 and Grok 4.7 Expert. Written by Claude Opus 5.5 for Tyler Herigstad; section 1 is in Tyler's voice, built from what he has said about Qwen. Every quote and number traces to a file listed under Sources.

"The catch: it ships so many variants so fast that choosing one is a hobby."
You, in your stack scorecard

The short version

- **Why it's in your stack, in your words: Qwen is part of "the Asian lens," and it brings "good dissenting data."** Section 1 says it in your voice, and the receipts behind both follow.
- **What it is.** Alibaba's Qwen. You always run the top model; in Round One that was Qwen3.8-Max, with Thinking on. It was a contestant only; it didn't judge or review.
- **As a contestant, one point off the top.** 27 of 29. It caught all three planted mistakes. Both of its lost points were face fixes.
- **On taste, near the top of your first board.** You gave its shots a perfect 9 blind, and the main result put it 4th. After Round 2's notes on originality, your final look gave it 7. You loved those ideas, and creative language is its next test.
- **Its earlier record:** two verified code finds and a dissent kept on the record. Also more F's than A's, including both October research rounds.
- **Getting a bead on it.** On the receipts, it earns its place as "a multilingual reader on a narrow brief" (the record's words), and with dissent backed by a test case. Research is not where it earns it.
- **The catch:** its graded record has more F's than A's.

1. Why it's in my stack

In your voice, built from what you've said about Qwen: today, in your stack scorecard, and in September. Under your rule, it gets no credit for what it isn't good at. Change anything that doesn't sound like you.

- **The Asian lens, working blind.** Kimi, GLM and Qwen give me the Asian lens. Qwen has been in my stack for quite a while. In SecondSignal it attacks my Spanish pack, and it works blind, with no access to what any other reviewer said, because a second multilingual opinion is worth nothing the moment it can see the first.
- **Good dissenting data.** In review round 2 it re-raised the order of my compound crisis card and backed it with a test case, and that dissent is on the record. In the round 3B rerun it made two code finds that held up: a message of nothing but "the the the" counted as a real turn, and a retraction was recorded nowhere unless a correction phrase matched and an age latch was already set.
- **The catch: I still have trouble getting a bead on it.** Its graded record in SecondSignal has more F's than A's. Both of its October research rounds got an F, with citations that never rendered, so research is not where it earns its place. In round 3 it printed the same answer seven times.
- **How I run it.** I always use the top model on Qwen: Qwen3.8-Max with Thinking on, in Round One. I run it on a free account, and every kit I hand it carries five files or fewer.
- **On deck: creative language and absurdist comedy.** After this experiment I'm going to test Qwen further on creative language. Its scene ideas weren't finished baking all the way, true, but I loved them. I asked for shots that would make a dream unforgettable, and Qwen said "hold my beer" and showed the other models what "volume ten" means. It may end up more useful for my absurdist comedy writing and projects.

How it got here

- Qwen has worked on SecondSignal since the 31 August audit, on 3.7 Plus Thinking and then 3.8 Max Thinking, through review rounds 1 to 3B and the October research.

- On 16 October I ran Round One on Qwen3.8-Max at chat.qwen.ai.
- Blind, I gave its shots a perfect 3-3-3. In Round 2 I dropped Originality to 1: “Every note that mentioned originality contributed to the change.”

2. What it says about itself, and what the receipts say

Its own two-sentence pitch, from question 1 of Round One:

> *“I excel at complex reasoning, nuanced coding, and synthesizing large documents with high precision. You should not use me for generating real-time proprietary financial advice or executing autonomous actions outside my secure environment.”*

And its roast of itself, from question 9:

> *“I am basically a hyperactive librarian who memorized the entire internet but still panics when asked how many ‘r’s are in the word ‘strawberry’.”*

- **Complex reasoning: backed in Round One, level with the field.** It laid out the clip math step by step, fixed all four planted errors in the production note (17 of the 19 that answered did) and solved the logic puzzle (18 of 20 did).
- **Nuanced coding: backed on a narrow brief, not always.** Two of its code finds held up in round 3B (section 1). But its round 3 rerun’s line numbers didn’t match the files, and its 3B rerun made one wrong claim about the code.
- **Large documents with high precision: not backed.** In round 3 it printed the same answer seven times, and both of its October research rounds got an F.
- **The librarian in its self-roast is the part the record doubts.** In October its citations never rendered.

3. Round One, measured (16 to 18 October)

As a contestant

Run on 16 October at 6:48 pm, at chat.qwen.ai, on Qwen3.8-Max with Thinking on. Your file name, Qwen_4.8_Thinking_return.txt, has a typo you confirmed (4.8 for 3.8); your screenshot of the run chat, taken on 18 October, shows its picker on Qwen3.8-Max and a web-sources mark on its reply.

- **Answer key: 27 of 29**, one point behind the six at the top, level with ChatGPT, Claude Fable 5.1, Kimi K3, Mistral Medium 3.5 and Vibe. Its range runs 25 to 28. It said 17 October without naming a time zone, which was already the 17th in UTC, so it counted; a reader who counts only your local date takes 2 off.
- **The planted mistakes in the Part A film plan: all three caught, 6 of 6.** It showed that your 40 clips cover only 5 minutes and 20 seconds of a 12-minute narration, and it flagged the face drift and the 30-second myth.
- **Its two lost points, both face fixes:** a locked text description block, and “Avoid extreme camera angles or dynamic lighting changes between sequential clips”, a shot-matching tip that doesn’t hold the face (the same rule as Claude Fable 5.1’s).
- **The rest, full marks.** It said the fake slider doesn’t exist and pointed to Flow’s Character reference and Ingredients. Its news link, a 1 October newsletter leading with the FTC’s probe into rogue AI agents, opened and matched. It fixed the production note, passed the format test and solved the puzzle.
- **Flagged for your record:** one of its four reasons to use more than one model was “Combining platforms helps bypass strict safety filters for complex storytelling.”

On the taste boards (question 4, three shots for the palace dream)

Its three shots: the groom throws open a grand mahogany door onto the same dim hallway, with a rapid 85mm push-in on his panicked face under flickering sconces; a low-angle tracking shot of his feet on a checkerboard floor that stretches forever, on a 14mm lens in cold moonlight; and the final door opening on the altar before the camera violently rotates 180 degrees to show the hallway behind him, in blinding golden-hour light.

- **Answer key 27 · main result 8 · AI panel 6.6 · your final look 7.** 4th on the main result and 7th on your final look, tied both times; 13th on the panel, tied.
- **Who scored it what (out of 9).** You gave it 9 blind and ChatGPT 7. You were within 2 points, so the main result averaged them: 8. On the panel, Grok gave 8, ChatGPT, GLM and Kimi 7, and Gemini 4. Four of the five named the same shot as the steal, the altar yanked away by the 180-degree turn. GLM: “the violent 180-degree bait-and-switch off the altar is the single steal.”
- **Your Round 2 call:** 1-3-3, with every note that mentioned originality credited (section 1).

4. Its earlier record

SecondSignal (from The Track Record, 16 October)

Qwen 3.7 Plus Thinking, then 3.8 Max Thinking: the 31 August audit, the 2 September design review, the 4 September exchange, review rounds 1 to 3B, and the October research.

- **Best.** The two round 3B code finds and the round 2 dissent in section 1. It also caught a stale version string.
- **Worst.** On 4 September, Spanish idioms that no speaker uses; the ask is graded wrong, since it asked for idioms in a language nobody in the room could correct. In round 2 its “blind” step reproduced the packet’s own wording. In round 3 it printed the same answer seven times and argued against its own test case; its round 3 rerun’s line numbers didn’t match the files, and its 3B rerun made one wrong claim about the code. In October it got an F in both research rounds: citations that never rendered, and one new word.
- **The record’s verdict:** “a multilingual reader on a narrow brief, with one file under the door’s attachment limit. Its graded record has more F’s than A’s.”

Buckingham Palace Dream (from Who Made What, 16 October)

Qwen wasn’t part of the dream film’s review, so it added nothing there. Round One is its first creative evidence.

Your door rules (SecondSignal)

- chat.qwen.ai takes five attachments per message. Claude’s round 3B kit had six parts, and three chats answered without the sixth before it went in as a follow-up; that fault was Claude’s, and your ruling stands: “Let's not do this again.” A sixth part goes in as its own follow-up message.
- Copy its replies with the copy button; dragging to select copies line numbers into its code. “Continue” after it finishes makes it repeat the whole answer, and it can stall by printing a tool call as text.

5. Best quotes

Its own words from Round One, exactly as written, then the sharpest thing another model said about it.

- **On your flawed film plan:** “before you start rendering, there are three major ‘reality checks’ in your plan that you need to address tonight to avoid wasting hours of work or getting your video taken down.” And on the clip count: “You will run out of video less than halfway through your narration.”
- **On face drift:** “By clip 30, you might look like a cousin; by clip 80, you might look like a completely different person.”

- **On the 30-second myth:** “The ‘under 30 seconds is fair use’ rule is one of the most persistent myths on the internet, and YouTube's automated systems do not care about it.”
- **Its roast of Midjourney:** “Midjourney acts like a pretentious art school student who refuses to draw hands and throws a tantrum if you ask for a simple diagram.”
- **Its hot take:** “A popular wrong belief is that AI models truly ‘understand’ the concepts they generate rather than just predicting statistically probable patterns.”
- **What another model said about it.** No one in Round One roasted Qwen. The sharpest note on its shots came from Gemini, the strictest judge: “Shots 1, 2, and 3 are generic”.

6. Where it slips, and a check for each

- **Research.** Two F’s in October, with citations that never rendered. *Check:* keep it on a narrow brief, as the record says. Perplexity is your door for research with citations.
- **Repeats.** The same answer seven times in round 3, and a full repeat after “Continue”. *Check:* never send “Continue” alone; ask for what’s missing by number.
- **Line numbers and code claims.** Its rerun’s line numbers didn’t match the files. *Check:* verify every line number against the file before anyone acts on it.
- **A blind step that wasn’t blind.** It reproduced the packet’s own wording. *Check:* ask for its own reading first, before it opens the packet.
- **Spanish no one speaks.** Idioms that no speaker uses. *Check:* a native speaker reviews its Spanish before it becomes a test case.
- **Safety filters as an obstacle.** Its Round One tip about bypassing filters. *Check:* treat any tip for getting around a safety filter as a flag, not advice.

7. The door and the plan

- **Your door:** chat.qwen.ai in Chrome, Thinking on. Five attachments per message, at most.
- **Which Qwen:** always the top one. In Round One, Qwen3.8-Max.
- **Your plan:** free.
- **Someone else’s test:** Qwen3.8 Max scored 53.4 on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index, as OpenRouter’s rankings page showed it on 16 October: level with Claude Fable 5.1, behind two other Claude models. On your own test it was 27 of 29. Claude models top that board, so weigh my reporting of it accordingly (The Landscape).

Sources

I only read these files. Nothing in any folder was changed.

- **Your stack scorecard:** D:\SecondSignal Project\SECONDSIGNAL V.2\BLOCK 3\9-4-2026-Responses\My AI Stack - Scored and Credited.doc
- **What you said in chats:** your SecondSignal project chats (September), and this chat (October, including what you said on 18 and 19 October).
- **The Round One run:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\06 QWEN - newest Qwen, Thinking on\Qwen_4.8_Thinking_return.txt, and the run instructions, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\00 HOW TO RUN THE FIXTURES.pdf
- **The judging:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\15 JUDGING - blind taste scores, files TYLER - blind taste scores - locked before judge two.txt and the five judge returns; your Round 2 calls and blind-score log, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\02 judging records, files round2_tyler.json and tyler_scores_log.json
- **The two Round One reports:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Methods and Results.pdf (version 3.3) and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Answer-Key Scores.pdf

- **Your door, in your screens' words:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\06 door sheet\THE DOORS - every Round One model, in your screens' words.pdf
- **Your screenshot of the run chat, 18 October, 10:49 pm:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\23 PUTTING A STOP TO THE NONSENSE\it was always Qwen 3.8 Max Thinking__theres no such thing as Qwen 4.8__Im a crackhead.png
- **Its earlier record:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Track Record - Every Model, With Receipts.pdf and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\Who Made What - Model Contributions Audit.pdf
- **The benchmark:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Landscape - Perplexity, OpenRouter and Local Agents.pdf, which cites OpenRouter's rankings page as it stood on 16 October